

Kat McLaren

IT operations and cybersecurity professional with 3+ years' experience in cloud and endpoint management. Skilled in AWS, Python automation, and using ServiceNow to manage IT requests and incidents. Strong documentation and communication skills to support secure and efficient operations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SF Solidarity PAC

Canvasser & Phone Banker April – July 2026

- Delivered clear, persuasive explanations of campaign issues to audiences with varying levels of prior knowledge
- Managed challenging interpersonal interactions using conflict resolution and de-escalation techniques, maintaining professionalism under pressure

City College of San Francisco

CS Tutor Squad January – May 2026

- Tutored students in core computer science concepts, helping with tasks like code debugging, project planning, and technical problem-solving
- Adjusted teaching approach based on each student's skill level and learning style, guiding students toward independent problem solving

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

March 2022 – December 2025

NERSC Cyber Security Group

September 2025 – December 2025

- Deploying and configuring multiple Linux virtual machines and Docker containers to build and test open-source endpoint monitoring software
- Evaluating and comparing various monitoring tools for functionality, compatibility, and maintainability
- Documenting setup procedures, troubleshooting steps, and configuration workflows for internal use

Cloud/Cyber Security Group

October 2024 – August 2025

- Improved cloud and endpoint security posture using Wiz and AWS, identified and remediated security issues
- Developed Python script to automate communications by integrating with SendGrid
- Project Lead for AWS environment pentesting to ensure security of AWS and GCP accounts across the Laboratory by evaluating detection and alerting systems

Berkeley Center for Structural Biology

October 2022 – September 2024

- Developed Python scripts for file management and machine testing
- Primary system administrator, resolved issue with Dectris detector server drive failure, saving approximately \$500,000
- Configured Puppet and CheckMK servers to automate updates and monitoring, including OS upgrades, dependency remediation, and hardware improvements for beamline systems
- Documented all team processes and procedures using Confluence
- Spot Award: Record yearly productivity - over 60,000 crystals analyzed

CONTACT

- San Francisco, CA
- 415-676-1098
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- [Portfolio website](#)
- [LinkedIn](#)

SKILLS

Programming:

- Python
- Unix/Linux command line
- Puppet
- C++
- Django
- JavaScript

System Administration:

- Linux
- CheckMK
- SSL Certificates
- Apache
- Database management
- Virtual machines
- Docker

Cloud Security:

- Wiz, Prowler
- AWS, GCP
- SumoLogic
- Zeek

Business Skills:

- Ticketing systems - ServiceNow
- Adaptable and Flexible
- Analytical problem solver
- Strategic decision maker
- Detailed documentation
- Conflict resolution and de-escalation
- Self-motivated
- Solutions oriented - willing and able to overcome obstacles

AWARDS/CERTIFICATES

AWS

Certified Cloud Practitioner Aug 2025

CCSF Dean's List

Achieved 4.0 GPA May 2024

CCSF Certificates of Achievement

C++ Programming May 2024

Cybersecurity Dec 2023

Network Security Dec 2023

Berkeley Lab Spot Awards

- BCSB Record productivity of over 60,000 crystals analyzed 2023
- Password software eval and implementation

Workstation Support

March – September 2022

- Processed support requests for hardware and software issues on Mac, Windows, Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, etc.) Chrome OS, iOS, Android
- Performed routine endpoint administration including imaging, configuring, and deploying laptops and workstations for users across multiple platforms
- Timely management and scheduling of service requests using ServiceNow, keeping well within defined SLAs
- Project Lead collaborating with security and IT operations team to evaluate password reset and disk encryption software

GameStop - New York, NY and Jersey City, NJ

Sr. Sales Associate/Shift Lead

January 2017 – August 2019

- Managed merchandising, inventory, shipments, and employee training
- Managed team day-to-day, delegated tasks
- Offered promotion at New Jersey location to revitalize operations and boost performance
- Promoted sales and achieved \$3,000 above colleagues during 2018 holiday season

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

AWS Threat Simulation

Cyber Security, Berkeley Labs

- Simulated attacker scenarios in AWS (S3, EC2, Lambda) to assess detection coverage with Wiz, Prowler, Zeek, and CloudTrail
- Compared Prowler vs. Wiz for AWS security monitoring and presented findings to cloud security team to guide software purchasing decision

Password Reset Tools Project

IT Support, Berkeley Labs

- Evaluated, selected and implemented tool
- Documented and presented findings
- Received Spot Recognition Award for initiative

IBM Good Tech Scholars Program

Remote

- Researched clean energy alternatives
- Developed chatbot using IBM Watson Assistant API
- Led presentation of group project to panel of IBM judges

2022

Sophos encryption testing

2022

NextGen Cyber Talent Grant

Awarded for achievements in cybersecurity courses

2021

EDUCATION

CCSF Associate of Sciences

Mathematics

Fall 2026

Computer Science

Spring 2026

CNIT: Cybersecurity

May 2024

General Assembly

Full-Stack Web Dev

Jan 2020

NYU Associate of Arts

Art History

May 2014

EXTRACURRICULARS

- OutLoud Sports Kickball
- CCDC competitor
- SF Bookworms Club Founder
- LBNL D&D Club Lead
- SF LGBT Center Volunteer
- BSides Conference Volunteer